

Six Sub-Neptunes

For Cello + Modular Synthesizer

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Pitches

This piece uses notes inspired by distances between planets (HD110067 Star System) so some notes are specified to be sharp or flat by a number of cents. The numbers are a guide and a target- absolute precision is not expected for non-synthesizer instruments, though players may consider playing to a tuner.

Players may explore dynamics at will. The synth-player should take care not to avoid excessive complex modulation that may obscure the pitches- a simple subtractive synth voice is recommended.

Structure

Players should slowly play through the notes twice in ascending order in unison.

After this, players are free to move between notes independently at will.

Notes should be held for the length of time it takes the player's eyes to travel to the next note.

When crossing asteroids or nebula, the player should sonify this. Suggested approaches below.

After approximately 5 minutes of exploration, players should slowly play through the notes twice in descending order, sustaining the final note for at least 20 seconds before fading to silence.

Sound Effects (Cello)

The player may use delay or other pedals to enhance effects.

Nebula/Dust/Atmosphere

Lighten the right-hand pressure to the point of white noise
Mute with left-hand.

Asteroids

Play the same note but pizzicato.
Tap the body of the cello with your fingers.

Sound Effects (Synthesizer)

Nebula/Dust/Atmosphere

Noise injected into the signal path of the main voice.
Noise modulating the pitch or filter frequency.
Noise shaped through a resonant filter as a separate voice.

Asteroids

Filter pings with various modulation processed via time-based effects.
Stepped modulation to filter of main voice.

